PARAPHRASING AND SUMMARIZING

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Functional English (SS1012)

PARAPHRASING:

Paraphrasing means **rewriting someone else's ideas in your own words** while keeping the original meaning the same.

Why Paraphrase?

- To show understanding of the source
- To avoid plagiarism
- To make information fit smoothly into your writing

Original:
"Technology has changed the way people communicate."

Paraphrased:
People now interact differently because of technological advancements.

WHAT DOES CORRECT PARAPHRASING LOOK LIKE?

- Wording must change.
- Sentence structure must change.
- The only way you can accomplish this is by reading, understanding and restating in YOUR OWN WORDS.

STEPS FOR PARAPHRASING

- Change to Synonyms
- Change Word Forms
- Change from Quoted Speech to Indirect Speech
- Change from Active Voice to Passive Voice
- Interpret Meaning: Identify the underlying meaning of a statement.
- Change Transitions



CHANGE TO SYNONYMS

- Replace the original words with words that mean the same
- **Example:**

  The lawyer was **content** with his life.

  The lawyer was **happy** with his life.

CHANGE WORD FORMS

- Use an adverb instead of an adjective
- Use a verb to replace a noun.
- **Example:**

  Angela is an **accurate**(adjective) **typist**(noun).

  Angela **types**(verb) **accurately**(adverb).



CHANGE FROM QUOTED SPEECH TO INDIRECT SPEECH

- Mrs. Mamac, **“I am ready for lunch.”**
- Mrs. Mamac said **she was ready for lunch**.

CHANGE FROM ACTIVE VOICE TO PASSIVE VOICE

- A hotel employee will **carry** your bags.
- Your bags will be **carried** by a hotel employee.

INTERPRET MEANING: IDENTIFY THE UNDERLYING MEANING OF A STATEMENT.

- Anthea, “I am ready for lunch.”
- Anthea **complained about being hungry.**



CHANGE TRANSITIONS

- Although it was raining, Vincy walked to work.
- It was raining, **but** Vincy walked to work.
- It was raining; **however**, Vincy walked to work.

Original Text

"Business communication is increasingly taking place internationally – in all countries, among all peoples, and across all cultures. An awareness of other cultures – of their languages, customs, experiences and perceptions – as well as an awareness of the way in which other people conduct their business, are now essential ingredients of business communication"

Paraphrase# 1

More and more business communication is taking place internationally—across all countries, peoples, and cultures. Awareness of other cultures and the way in which people do business are essential parts of business communication



COMPARE THE ORIGINAL AND PARAPHRASE

- Too much of the original is quoted directly, with only a few words changed or omitted. The words in red are too similar to the original quote:

More and more business communication is taking place internationally—across all countries, peoples, and cultures. Awareness of other cultures and the way in which people do business are essential parts of business communication



PARAPHRASE# 2

- The importance of understanding the traditions, language, perceptions, and the manner in which people of other cultures conduct their business should not be underestimated, and it is a crucial component of business communication.

- The original's ideas are summarized and expressed in the writer's own words with minimal overlap with the original text's language:



SUMMARIZING

- Summarizing means **condensing the main ideas of a text into a shorter version** using your own words. It includes **only the key points**, leaving out details and examples.

Why Summarize?

- To show understanding of the main ideas
- To review or study efficiently
- To present information briefly and clearly



1. **Reread:** Reread the original passage until you understand its full meaning.
2. **Find the main idea:** Ask yourself, “What is the main idea that the author is communicating?”
3. **Avoid copying:** Set the original aside, and write one or two sentences with the main point of the original on a note card or in a notes document.
4. **Connect:** Jot down a few words below your summary to remind you later how you envision using this material.
5. **Check:** Check your version of writing with the original to make sure that your version accurately expresses all the essential information in a new form.
6. **Quote:** Use quotation marks to identify any unique term or phraseology you have borrowed exactly from the source.
7. **Cite:** Record the source (including the page) on your note card or notes document so that you can credit it easily if you decide to incorporate the material into your paper.

EXAMPLES:

Original Text

"Business communication is increasingly taking place internationally – in all countries, among all peoples, and across all cultures. An awareness of other cultures – of their languages, customs, experiences and perceptions – as well as an awareness of the way in which other people conduct their business, are now essential ingredients of business communication"

Summary

- Business communication is worldwide, and it is essential to build awareness of other cultures and the way in which other people conduct their business

COMPARE THE ORIGINAL AND SUMMARY

- Too much of the original is quoted directly, with only a few words changed or omitted. The highlighted words are too similar to the original text:

- Business communication is worldwide, and it is essential to build awareness of other cultures and the way in which other people conduct their business.
- It is important to evaluate your summary to see if it is in your own words. It is best to read the original text, then read the summary, and look for phrases or language that are too similar to the original text.

SUMMARY 2

- In a world that is increasingly connected, effective business communication requires us to learn about other cultures, languages, and business norms.
- The original's ideas are summarized and expressed in the writer's own words with minimal overlap:



Two main ways to avoid plagiarism are **paraphrasing** and **summarizing**—but they are different!

Feature	Paraphrase	Summary
Definition	Restating information from a source in your **own words** and keeping the **same meaning and detail.**	Giving the **main idea only** from a larger text, making it **much shorter.**
Length	About the **same length** as the original text.	**Much shorter** than the original.
Purpose	To show understanding of the author's ideas while writing in your own style.	To present only the key points or overall meaning.
Example	**Original:** "Social media has changed the way people communicate across the world." **Paraphrase:** People all over the world now interact differently because of social media.	**Summary:** Social media transformed global communication.
Citation	✅ Must include a citation.	✅ Must include a citation.

Original:

"Social media has changed the way people communicate across the world."

Paraphrase:

People all over the world now interact differently because of social media.

Summary:

Social media transformed global communication.



CLASS ACTIVITY

- **Paraphrase and summarize each paragraph:**

1. Reading regularly can significantly improve a person's ability to concentrate and think critically. It helps expand vocabulary, enhances imagination, and develops empathy by allowing readers to experience different lives and perspectives. Moreover, reading before bed can reduce stress and improve sleep quality.

2. Climate change has become one of the biggest global challenges. Rising temperatures, melting glaciers, and extreme weather patterns threaten ecosystems and human livelihoods. Scientists believe that immediate action, such as reducing carbon emissions and switching to renewable energy sources, is necessary to protect the planet for future generations.

3. Time management is a valuable skill that helps individuals achieve their goals efficiently. By organizing tasks, setting priorities, and avoiding procrastination, people can reduce stress and increase productivity. Good time management also allows for a healthy balance between work, study, and personal life.

